Navid **Sheybani**

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Education

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL — Expected 2030
Major: Neuroscience, S.B. | **Minor**: Health and Society
Relevant Coursework: Principles of Biology, Statistical Methods and Applications, General Comprehensive Chemistry I, Calculus I/II, Intermediate Persian I

Research Interests

Cognitive neuroscience, attention and memory, computational neuroimaging, neurodisability, sleep and brain health, developmental social cognition, neuroimmunology, applications in health policy and special populations.
Geographic: North America, West Asia-North Africa, Western Europe, East Asia

Professional Service

University of Chicago Philosophy Review — Sept. 2026 – Present
Staff Editor

Accessibility Student Advisory Board, University of Chicago Office of the Provost — Oct. 2026 – Present
Board Member

Research Experience

Test-Format Anticipation in Visual Working Memory Capacity — Sep. 2026 – Present
Associate Researcher, Institute for Mind and Biology, University of Chicago — Chicago, IL
Advisor: Edward K. **Vogel**, Ph.D.; Supervisor: Gengshi **Hu**, B.S.

- Ran human EEG and eye-tracking sessions for a study of how anticipating a memory test's format (4 iterations: change detection, two-alternative choice, nine-color grid, or random combination) shapes visual working memory. Handled cap fitting, electrode gelling to low impedance, eye-tracker calibration, and mid-session signal monitoring and re-gelling.
- Improved developed experimental task in Python (*PsychoPy*), porting legacy MATLAB code. Implemented lateralized cued memory arrays, real-time gaze-contingent trial rejection (*EyeLink*), and condition-coded EEG triggers locked to screen flips.
- Traced artifactual pre-stimulus decoding of set size (˜75%) to a ˜9.5 ms display lag on three-item arrays (16/16 subjects, $t(15) = 50.4$) that time-shifted the cue-evoked ERP. Rewrote the display loop with a persistent stimulus pool and Vsync-anchored flip scheduling for frame-exact phases at 120 Hz, plus a timing harness that cross-checks flip timestamps against amplifier-clock EEG markers.

Effect of Physical Dorm Environments on Out-group Interactions — Jul. 2026 – Present
Associate Researcher, Department of Psychology & Neuroscience, Duke University & Department of Psychology, University of Chicago — Durham, NC & Chicago, IL
Advisors: Sarah E. **Gaither** Ph.D. (Duke), & Marc G. **Berman**, Ph.D. (UChicago)

- Investigated how the physical design of residence halls shapes cross-race and cross-class interaction among college students across 4+ residential sites at Duke and UChicago, bridging intergroup contact

research with environmental psychology.
- Ran multi-site observational protocols and reviewed the intergroup contact, residential diversity, and belonging literatures to identify predictors of student belonging. Managed field logistics, longitudinal participant tracking across study phases, and quality-controlled data entry across sites.
- Helping design a quasi-experimental study in which a greenery intervention (adding plants to shared living spaces) is introduced in some residence halls but not others, to test whether it changes how students from the same or different socioeconomic backgrounds perceive one another. Comparing randomly assigned with student-selected housing placements to separate the intervention's effect from self-selection confounds.

Ideological Barriers to Socialist Policy Reform in the United States Jul. 2025 – Aug. 2026
Independent Visiting Researcher, School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences, University of Texas at Dallas Richardson, TX
Advisor: Euel W. **Elliott**

- Investigated why socialist-leaning policy proposals meet resistance among U.S. voters, examining the psychological and political factors that shape how people perceive economic systems and policymaking.
- Designed and carried out an independent political-economy study comparing expert economic consensus with voters' economic literacy and electoral behavior, to locate where public opinion diverges from expert assessment.
- Conducting post-hoc analyses testing whether gaps in economic literacy predict policy opposition independently of partisan identity and ideological self-placement; academic year-based LoA until Summer 2027

Research Affiliations

Environmental Neuroscience Lab, Department of Psychology, University of Chicago Jul. 2026–Present
Project-based Undergraduate Research Assistant Chicago, IL
PI: Marc G. **Berman**, Ph.D.
Graduate Supervisor: Elizabeth A. **Janey**, B.S.

Awh/Vogel Lab, Department of Psychology, University of Chicago Aug. 2026–Present
Undergraduate Research Assistant Chicago, IL
PIs: Edward K. **Vogel**, Ph.D & Edward S. **Awh**, Ph.D.
Graduate Supervisor: Gengshi **Hu**, B.S.

Scholarships and Grants

* **University of Chicago Grant I/II (Scholarship)**, 2026–2030, University of Chicago. **$283,840**
* **First Phoenix Scholarship**, 2026–2030, University of Chicago. **$20,000**
* **UChicago Careers in Healthcare Grant**, 2027, Jeff Metcalf Internship Program. **$5,000**
* **Phoenix STEM Program**, 2026–2027, Neubauer Family Foundation, University of Chicago. **$600**

* Listed by award size.

Certifications

* **Conflicts of Interest**, Exp. Jul. 2030, CITI Program
* **Responsible Conduct of Research (RCR) Course**, Exp. Jul. 2030, CITI Program
* **Human Subjects Protection: Social and Behavioral Research**, Exp. Jul. 2029, CITI Program
* **Race in Clinical Research: Ethics and IRB Decision Making**, Exp. Jul. 2029, CITI Program

* **Social Sciences Course on Health Information Privacy and Security**, Exp. Jul. 2029, CITI Program
* **HIPPA Awareness Certified**, Exp. Jul. 2028, *HIPAATraining.com*

* Listed by expiration date.

Skills

Natural Languages	English (native), Persian (heritage/fluent), Spanish (B1, Texas State Seal of Biliteracy [2026])
Programming Languages	Python (working), LaTeX (working)
Documents	Microsoft 365 (proficient), Google Docs (proficient)
Laboratory	hypothesis testing, experimental design, scientific writing/grant proposals, literature synthesis, electroencephalogram (EEG)

Last updated: October 21, 2026